



Sucher

A standalone device search – files, contacts and calendar events in one field. This guide covers setup and use.

Version 0.27 · GNU GPLv3 · split off from EdgeTab in 2026

Source & APK: github.com/8818freak/Sucher

All screenshots are from real use – personal content has been redacted.

1 What is Sucher?

Sucher searches file *names* AND file *content* (text, Office, PDF, e-books, comic metadata) as well as contacts and calendar events – all in one field. Unlike an edge panel it isn't an always-on service: open, search, done.

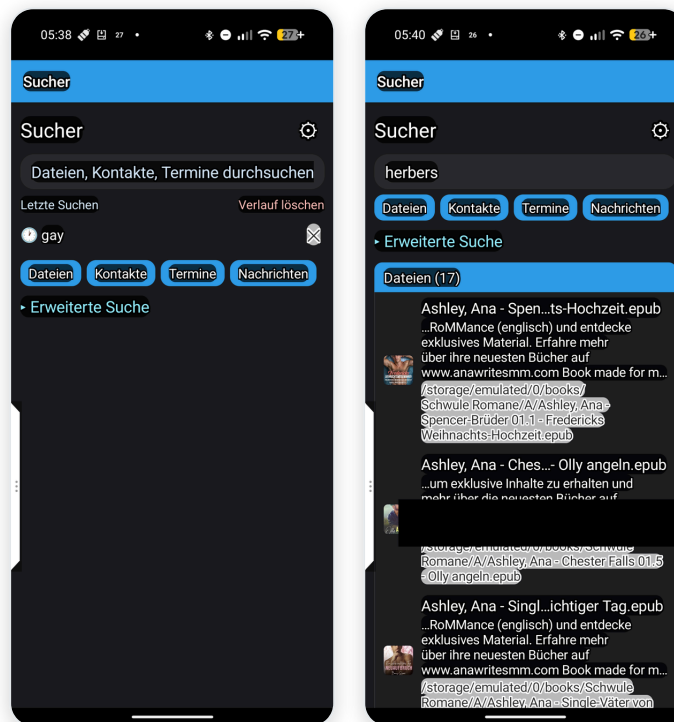
Free, open source (GNU GPLv3), no ads, no analytics, no internet permission. Runs on any Android device from version 10.

2 Setup

First grant file access (its own system screen) and choose at least one folder. Easiest: the **“Search internal storage”** button adds the whole internal storage directly; **“+ Add another folder”** lets you pick more. Per folder you can enable **“Make content searchable”** – then the full text is indexed in addition to the name (more storage, takes longer).

3 Searching

Type into the field; the chips *Files / Contacts / Events / Messages* narrow the source. Full-text hits show the matching passage as a snippet.

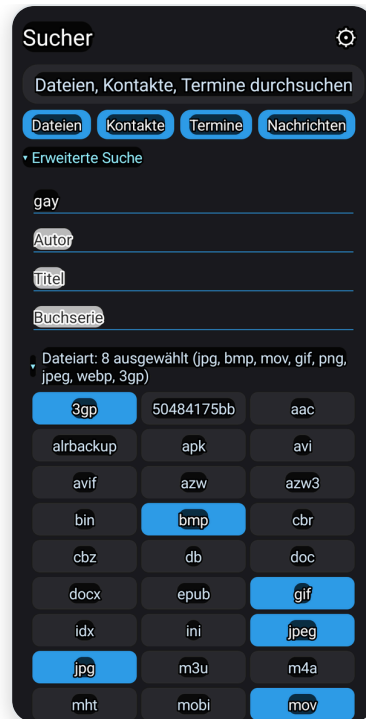


Search home screen

Full-text hits with snippet

4 Advanced search

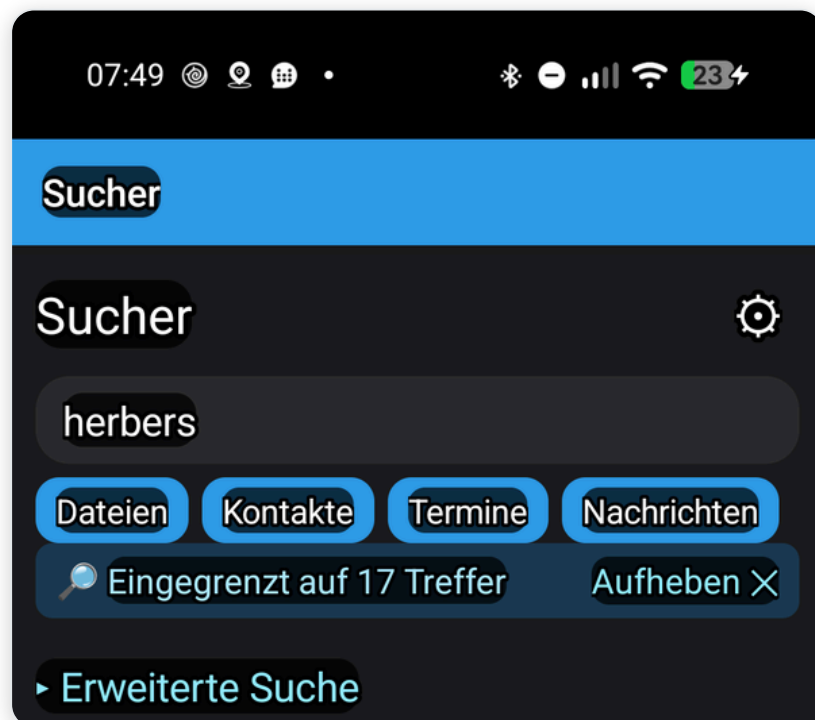
Via “Advanced search”, filter specifically by **author**, **title**, **book series**, **file type** and **date** – ideal for large book and document collections.



Author/title/series/type/date

5 Narrowing results

After any search, “🔍 **search only within these N hits**” restricts every following search to exactly that result set – repeatable, until cleared. A broad first search can thus be refined step by step instead of building one giant combined query.



Narrowing the result set

6 Index & automatic refresh

The index remembers each file's modification time and skips everything unchanged on the next run – so follow-up runs are fast. “Reindex now” starts a run by hand; “Automatically refresh in the background every few hours” keeps the index fresh. “Quit Sucher” stops a running index immediately.

“Reindex” – does it wipe or extend the index?

It **extends/updates** it; it does not wipe it. A run walks the chosen folders and compares each file's modification time with the index: unchanged files are skipped, changed files are re-read, new files are added. Only files that no longer exist (deleted or moved) are removed from the index. An interrupted run therefore never leaves a broken state – just a subset the next run finishes.

What if a file is replaced by one with the same name?

It gets re-indexed. Replacing a file changes its modification time (usually its size too); on the next run Sucher detects this and re-reads the metadata and – if content indexing is enabled for that folder – the full text. The old content is replaced by the new.

Why does indexing sometimes stop and restart?

That is intended and harmless. To save battery, Android gives each background pass only a limited time window. A **first full-text run** over many books/PDFs is compute-heavy and often doesn't fit into a single window – so it is done in several passes. Each pass continues, by modification time, exactly where the last left off; nothing is lost and nothing is done twice. Once the index is complete, later runs are short. (A *frequent*, seconds-fast stop/restart used to indicate an unreadable root folder – see the box below – which is now fixed.)

If a chosen folder isn't listable (e.g. “/storage/emulated” itself – only “/storage/emulated/0” is accessible), it is automatically mapped to the internal storage and the index is left untouched. A note about it appears in the diagnostics log.

7 Backup & restore

Settings AND the complete search index (all full text already captured) can be backed up to a file and restored from it – handy before switching devices, so the time-consuming indexing isn't needed again.

8 Diagnostics

In the settings, a diagnostics log shows what the indexer did last and where it currently is (folder/file, counters). That makes it possible to see, without a cable, if something ever gets stuck; a “Problematic files” list names files that triggered a hang (and are therefore indexed by name only).